

Tyler Han

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EDUCATION

- **University of Washington** June 2022 - Present
Ph.D. Computer Science Advisor: [Byron Boots](#)
- **University of Maryland** Sep 2018 - May 2022
B.S. Aerospace Engineering | B.S. Computer Science | Minor: Mathematics GPA: 3.9 / 4.0

RESEARCH INTEREST

I am interested in methods which enable robots to attain the same level of efficiency and robustness as animals. With experience in field engineering and robotics, I am heavily influenced by real-world deployment.

PUBLICATIONS

1. Tyler Han, Bat Nemekhbold, Siyang Shen, Rohan Bajjal, Richard Ebock, Harine Ravichandiran, Sanghun Jung, Kevin Huang, Byron Boots. "Online World Modeling Enables Real-World Inverse Reinforcement Learning from Observation", *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
2. Tyler Han, Yanda Bao, Bhaumik Mehta, Gabriel Guo, Anubhav Vishwakarma, Emily Kang, Sanghun Jung, Rosario Scalise, Bryan Xu, Byron Boots. "Model Predictive Adversarial Imitation Learning for Planning from Observation", *International Conference on Learning Representations (ICLR)*, 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)
3. Tyler Han, Preet Shah, Sidharth Rajagopal, Yanda Bao, Sanghun Jung, Sidharth Talia, Gabriel Guo, Bryan Xu, Bhaumik Mehta, Emma Romig, Rosario Scalise, Byron Boots. "Wheeled Lab: Modern Sim2Real for Low-Cost, Open-source Wheeled Robotics", *Conference on Robot Learning (CoRL)*, 2025. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
4. Tyler Han, Alex Liu, Alex Spitzer, Guanya Shi, Byron Boots. "Model Predictive Control for Aggressive Driving Over Uneven Terrain", *Robotics: Science and Systems (RSS)*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)
5. Chuning Zhu, Xinqi Wang, Tyler Han, Simon Du, Abhishek Gupta. "Distributional Successor Features Enable Zero-Shot Policy Optimization", *Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#) [\[website\]](#)

PREPRINTS

1. Anubhav Vishwakarma, Caleb Hsu, Byron Boots, Karen Leung, Tyler Han. "Discriminative Barrier Functions for Safe Adversarial Imitation Learning from Observation", 2026. [\[pdf\]](#)
2. Tyler Han, Sidharth Talia, Rohan Panicker, Preet Shah, Neel Jawale, Byron Boots. "Dynamics Models in the Aggressive Off-Road Driving Regime", *International Conference on Robotics and Automation (ICRA). Workshop on Off-Road Autonomy*, 2024. [\[pdf\]](#)

PROJECTS

- **Wheeled Lab** February 2025 - Present
University of Washington 
 - Full low-cost development ecosystem and pathway (WL@UW) for students new to RL in robotics. [\[website\]](#)
- **Robotic Autonomy in Complex Environments with Resiliency (RACER)** June 2022 - May 2024
Defense Advanced Research Projects Agency (DARPA) 
 - Planning & control for autonomous high-speed field UGV of top performing team, now Overland AI
- **Autonomous Tunnel Boring** Sep 2020 - May 2022
The Boring Company | Not-a-Boring Competition
 - Navigation; one of twelve out of over 400 global TBM system proposals selected to compete onsite at Las Vegas

HONORS AND AWARDS

- **Best Paper Finalist** September 2025
Resource-Rational Robot Learning, CoRL 2025
- **Graduate Research Fellowship Program (GRFP)** March 2023
National Science Foundation

SERVICE

- Guest Speaker at Global Innovation Exchange, University of Washington
- Organizer and Award Committee Member: RSS 2025 Off-Road Autonomy Workshop
- Invited to Review: RA-L, T-RO, ICRA, RSS Off-Road Workshop, CoRL, NeurIPS

MEDIA

- “National Robotics Week – Latest Physical AI Research, Breakthroughs and Resources”, NVIDIA, 2025 [\[link\]](#)
- “From Simulation to Reality: Building Wheeled Robots with Isaac Lab”, Q&A Talk, 2025 [\[link\]](#)

OUTREACH & MENTORING

• Robotics Research Mentoring

June 2023 - Present

Robot Learning Lab

- Master’s Students: Siyang Shen → Paxini, Anubhav Vishwakarma → FieldAI, Preet Shah → Research Engineer at General Robotics, Alex Liu → Software Engineer at Amazon
- Undergraduate Students: Laura Wang, Urvi Rutia, Bhaumik Mehta, Bryan Xu, Yanda Bao, Sidharth Rajagopal, Gabe Guo, Alyssa Giedd → Ph.D. at University of Washington
- High School Students: Vansh Chhabra

• Pre-Application Mentorship Program

September 2022 - Present

University of Washington, Department of Computer Science & Engineering



- Mentor to students in under-represented or underserved communities considering graduate school